

TEAM TRAINING TOOLKIT

People Buy People.

Master the art of connection.

Marketing Sweet · Whole-team training

IN THIS TOOLKIT

- 01 Listening > talking · the real skill
- 02 Adapt to who's in front of you
- 03 Acknowledge before you solve
- 04 Remember the small details
- 05 Confidence + humility together
- 06 Daily reference card

01 · THE UNDER-PRACTISED SKILL

Listen Better. Don't Talk More.

Connection is built by listening, not by dominating.

HEARING · PASSIVE

- ✗ Sound reaches your ear
- ✗ Brain waits for its turn
- ✗ Response already forming
- ✗ No details actually stick
- ✗ Person feels processed

LISTENING · ACTIVE

- ◆ Paying attention
- ◆ Remembering details
- ◆ Showing genuine interest
- ◆ Asking one more question
- ◆ Person feels valued

STOP WAITING FOR YOUR TURN TO SPEAK

Most conversations quietly become competitions. Instead of listening, we're planning our reply. Real listening is different — become curious. Ask another question. Dig deeper. Let people explain themselves.

THE REWARD · TWO WINS FROM ONE HABIT CHANGE

The more they talk → more connected they feel + more you learn about what will help them.

02 · MEET THEM WHERE THEY ARE

Adapt to Who's in Front of You

Not everyone communicates the same way.

DIRECT

Get to the point. No small talk. Speed up.

ANALYTICAL

Wants detail, data, precision. Slow down.

EMOTIONAL

Wants to be heard, connect first. Warm up.

SOCIAL

Enjoys small talk. Let the rapport build.

THE MUSIC ANALOGY · YOU'RE NOT FOR EVERYONE

Some people love rock. Others prefer classical. Preferences are personal and won't shift. People are exactly the same — you're never going to be everyone's favourite. And that's fine.

YOUR JOB

Not to be liked by everyone — to communicate in a way that gives you the best chance of connecting with the person in front of you. Same you. Slightly recalibrated.

03 · ORDER OF OPERATIONS

Acknowledge Before You Solve

People want to be understood — then helped.

SOLVE-FIRST · WELL-MEANING

**Buyer shares frustration —
you jump to fix.**

Feels efficient. Communicates "the info was the point." The feeling gets skipped over. Help feels dismissive even when it's good help.

→ **BUYER FEELS PROCESSED**

ACKNOWLEDGE-FIRST · RIGHT ORDER

**Slow the pace. Reflect.
Question. THEN solve.**

"That sounds hard. Let me check I've got this — you're saying...?" Person feels heard. THEN the help lands properly.

→ **BUYER FEELS UNDERSTOOD**

APPLIES INSIDE THE BUSINESS TOO

Teammates want to feel heard. Managers want to feel heard. Direct reports want to feel heard. The strongest teams aren't built because everyone agrees — they're built because everyone feels respected, regardless of whose view carried the day.

LISTENING → RESPECT → TRUST → GREAT TEAMS

04 · THE EASIEST HABIT

Remember the Small Details

Five seconds of a call. Enormous trust over time.

WHAT TO NOTE + BRING UP NEXT TIME

- ◆ **Names** Their name. Their partner's. Their kids'. Their staff.
- ◆ **Hobbies** The sport, the dog, the project they mentioned.
- ◆ **Family** The daughter's soccer season. The son's exam week.
- ◆ **Life events** The holiday coming up. The birthday. The move.

WHY SMALL BEATS BIG

"How's your daughter's soccer season going?" carries more weight than any elaborate present. It shows you cared enough to remember. Elaborate gestures can feel performed. Small details can't — you either remembered, or you didn't.

→ **This is the invisible work competitors don't do. It's why some client relationships are untouchable.**

GENUINE INTEREST CAN'T BE FAKED

People are extraordinarily good at detecting scripted questions. Same question — "how's your week been?" — completely different felt tone depending on whether you actually want to know. Solution isn't better scripts. It's real curiosity.

05 · THE FINAL PRINCIPLE

Confidence + Humility

Carry both. One without the other doesn't work.

CONFIDENCE

Knows what you have to offer is valuable.
Holds the position without needing to defend it loudly. Buyers feel it.

→ **BUYERS TRUST YOU**

ARROGANCE

Confidence without humility. Proves itself by belittling others. Buyers feel this too — and pull away.

→ **BUYERS PULL AWAY**

CARRY BOTH · THE STANDARD

Confidence knows what you have to offer has genuine value. Humility approaches every conversation ready to listen first, understand first, connect first — only THEN focusing on the solution. Both together produce the professional buyers want to work with.

THE LINE TO REMEMBER

"People don't remember the perfect script. They remember how you made them feel."

REFERENCE

Daily Card · Keep At Your Desk

The whole session on one page.

THE FRAME

- ◆ Before anything else — do I trust this person?
- ◆ People buy from people they LIKE. Comfort > polish.
- ◆ Scripts don't produce trust. Presence does.

THE LISTENING

- ◆ Listen better, don't talk more. Curiosity over cleverness.
- ◆ Stop planning your reply mid-sentence. Ask another question.
- ◆ The more they talk, the more connected they feel.

THE APPROACH

- ◆ Adapt to who's in front of you. Same you, recalibrated.
- ◆ Acknowledge FIRST. Then solve. Order matters.
- ◆ Don't rush. Long-term relationships beat short-term pressure.

THE HABITS

- ◆ Remember small details. Bring them up next time.
- ◆ Genuine interest can't be faked. Be curious for real.
- ◆ Confidence + humility together. Both. Always.

PEOPLE DON'T REMEMBER THE SCRIPT · THEY REMEMBER HOW YOU MADE THEM FEEL